

Chapter 8 — The Making of the National Movement: 1870s–1947

The one-line point: The whole freedom struggle in one chapter — **Moderates** → **Radicals** → **Gandhi's mass movements** → **Quit India** → **Independence and Partition**. ★★ ★ This is the single highest-value chapter in the entire NCERT History series. Read it three times.

← Ch.7 | Index |  **Final chapter**

Syllabus Classification

Field	Value
Subject	History → Modern India
Sub-discipline	The Indian National Movement
Period	1870s – 1947
Prelims (GS Paper I)	★★★★★ <i>"History of India and INDIAN NATIONAL MOVEMENT"</i> — this is the syllabus line itself
Mains (GS Paper I)	★★★★★ <i>"The Freedom Struggle — its various stages and important contributors/contributions from different parts of the country"</i>
Also feeds	Polity ★★★ (Gol Act 1935, Cabinet Mission, the making of the Constitution), Indian Society ★★ (communalism, Partition), Ethics ★★ (<i>ahimsa</i> , satyagraha), Essay ★★★
Weightage	★★★★★ — the highest in the series. Nothing else comes close.
Overlaps with	Class 10 Ch.2 (<i>Nationalism in India</i> — the same period in more depth), Class 12 Themes 11 and 12 (Gandhi; Framing the Constitution)

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this chapter you should be able to:

- ☐ **State the core nationalist answer** to *"what is this country and for whom is it meant?"* ★★ ★
- ☐ **Name the early political associations.** ★★ ★
- ☐ **Explain the three provocations** of the 1870s–80s: **Arms Act**, **Vernacular Press Act**, **Ilbert Bill**. ★★ ★
- ☐ **Describe the founding of the Congress (1885)** and name its early leaders. ★★ ★
- ☐ **List the Moderates' demands and methods**, and explain **Indianisation** and the **drain**. ★★ ★
- ☐ **Contrast the Radicals** — Lal, Bal, Pal — and state **Tilak's slogan**. ★★ ★
- ☐ **Explain the Partition of Bengal (1905)** and the **Swadeshi movement**. ★★ ★
- ☐ **Narrate the Muslim League (1906)**, **separate electorates (1909)**, the **Surat split (1907)**, and the **Lucknow Pact (1916)**. ★★ ★
- ☐ **Explain the economic and political impact of the First World War.** ★★ ★
- ☐ **Narrate Gandhi's arrival**, his early campaigns, and the **Rowlatt Satyagraha** and **Jallianwala Bagh**. ★★ ★

- ☐ Explain the **Khilafat–Non-Cooperation alliance** and list **how it took different forms across India**. ★★ ★
- ☐ Explain the **"people's Mahatma"** phenomenon. ★★ ★
- ☐ Narrate **Chauri Chaura**, the 1920s developments, **Simon**, and **Purna Swaraj**. ★★ ★
- ☐ Explain why **Gandhi chose salt**, and describe **Dandi**. ★★ ★
- ☐ Describe **women's participation**, including **Ambabai** and **Sarojini Naidu**. ★★ ★
- ☐ Narrate **Quit India**, **Bose** and the **INA**. ★★ ★
- ☐ Explain the **road to Partition** — 1937 elections, 1940 resolution, 1946 elections, **Cabinet Mission**, **Direct Action Day**. ★★ ★

Start Here: The Question That Created a Nation

*"The above-mentioned developments led the people to ask a crucial question: ★★ **WHAT IS THIS COUNTRY OF INDIA AND FOR WHOM IS IT MEANT?**"*

★★★ "The answer that gradually emerged was: **INDIA WAS THE PEOPLE OF INDIA — ALL the people irrespective of CLASS, COLOUR, CASTE, CREED, LANGUAGE, or GENDER. And the country, its resources and systems, WERE MEANT FOR ALL OF THEM.**"

*"With this answer came the awareness that **the British were exercising control over the resources of India and the lives of its people, and UNTIL THIS CONTROL WAS ENDED, INDIA COULD NOT BE FOR INDIANS.**"*

★★★ **Memorise this passage. It is the best short definition of Indian nationalism in any textbook, and it makes an ideal opening line for almost any Mains answer on the freedom struggle.**

Note what it does: it defines the nation **not by religion, language or race, but by inclusion** — and it derives the demand for independence **logically** from that definition. **If India belongs to all Indians, foreign control is by definition illegitimate.**

★ **And the key concept: SOVEREIGN** = *"the capacity to act independently without outside interference."* The associations *"worked with the idea that **the people should be SOVEREIGN — a MODERN CONSCIOUSNESS and a KEY FEATURE OF NATIONALISM...** the Indian people should be **empowered to take decisions regarding their affairs.**"*

★★ The Early Political Associations

*"This consciousness began to be clearly stated by the **political associations formed after 1850**, especially those of the **1870s and 1880s. Most of these were led by ENGLISH-EDUCATED PROFESSIONALS such as LAWYERS.**"*

Association

★ Poona Sarvajanik Sabha

★ Indian Association

★ Madras Mahajan Sabha

★ Bombay Presidency Association

★★ The Indian National Congress

★★ NCERT makes a lovely point about the name: *"**sarvajanik**" literally means "**of or for ALL THE PEOPLE**" (*sarva* = all + *janik* = of the people).

★ "*Though many of these associations functioned in **specific parts of the country**, their goals were stated as **THE GOALS OF ALL THE PEOPLE OF INDIA**, not those of any one region, community or class.*"

🔗 **Note the continuity from Chapter 6:** these were **English-educated professionals** — the exact class Macaulay's 1835 Act created. **The instrument designed to produce loyal subjects produced the leadership of the freedom movement.**

2 ★ ★ ★ Three Provocations, 1878–1883

*** 1878 -- THE ARMS ACT ***

"disallowing Indians from POSSESSING ARMS"

*** 1878 -- THE VERNACULAR PRESS ACT ***

"enacted in an effort to SILENCE THOSE WHO WERE CRITICAL OF THE GOVERNMENT. The Act allowed the government to CONFISCATE THE ASSETS OF NEWSPAPERS INCLUDING THEIR PRINTING PRESSES if the newspapers published anything found 'OBJECTIONABLE'."

*** 1883 -- THE ILBERT BILL ***

"The bill provided for the TRIAL OF BRITISH OR EUROPEAN PERSONS BY INDIANS, and sought EQUALITY BETWEEN BRITISH AND INDIAN JUDGES in the country."

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*** "But when WHITE OPPOSITION forced the government to WITHDRAW the bill, INDIANS WERE ENRAGED. The event HIGHLIGHTED THE RACIAL ATTITUDES OF THE BRITISH IN INDIA." ***

★★★ **The Ilbert Bill episode is the crucial one and is asked directly.** The lesson Indians drew was devastating: **the British would not accept legal equality even in principle, and organised white agitation could overturn government policy where Indian opinion could not.**

🎯 **It also taught a tactical lesson:** the Europeans had won by **organising**. *"**The need for an all-India organisation of educated Indians had been felt since 1880, but THE ILBERT BILL CONTROVERSY DEEPENED THIS DESIRE.**"* **The Congress was founded partly in imitation of the pressure group that had just defeated Indian interests.**

3 ★ ★ ★ The Indian National Congress, 1885

Fact	Detail
★ ★ ★ Founded	"The Indian National Congress was established when ★ 72 DELEGATES from all over the country met at ★ BOMBAY in DECEMBER 1885 "
★ ★ Early leadership	★ Dadabhai Naoroji, Pherozeshah Mehta, Badruddin Tyabji, W. C. Bonnerji, Surendranath Banerji, Romesh Chandra Dutt, S. Subramania Iyer — "largely from BOMBAY and CALCUTTA "
★ ★ Dadabhai Naoroji	"A businessman and publicist settled in LONDON , and for a time a MEMBER OF THE BRITISH PARLIAMENT , [who] guided the younger nationalists ". ★ His book Poverty and Un-British Rule in India "offered a scathing criticism of the ECONOMIC IMPACT of British rule "
★ ★ A. O. Hume	"A RETIRED BRITISH OFFICIAL also played a part in bringing Indians from the various regions together "

★ Two contemporary voices:

The Indian Mirror, January 1886: "The First National Congress at Bombay is **the NUCLEUS OF A FUTURE PARLIAMENT for our country.**"

Badruddin Tyabji, as President in **1887**: "This Congress is composed of the representatives, **not of any ONE class or community of India, but of ALL the different communities of India.**"*

★ **Publicist** = "someone who publicises an idea by circulating information, writing reports, speaking at meetings."

🎯 NCERT's activity asks why the Congress chose to speak for all Indians from the very **beginning** — and the answer is both principled and strategic. Principled, because of the definition of India in the opening passage. Strategic, because **a body claiming to represent only one community could never claim to represent the nation** — and the entire legitimacy of the demand for self-rule rested on that claim. **This is also exactly the claim the Muslim League would later contest.**

4 ★ ★ ★ The Moderates, 1885–1905

"It has often been said that the Congress in the **first twenty years** was ★ **'MODERATE' in its OBJECTIVES AND METHODS.**"

Their political demands

Demand
A greater voice for Indians in the government and administration
★ Legislative Councils to be made more representative , given more power , and introduced in provinces where none existed
★ ★ Indians to be placed in HIGH POSITIONS in government — and for this, ★ civil service examinations to be held IN INDIA as well, not just in London
★ Separation of the JUDICIARY from the EXECUTIVE
★ Repeal of the ARMS ACT
★ Freedom of SPEECH AND EXPRESSION

★ ★ ★ Why "Indianisation" mattered — two reasons

[1] AGAINST RACISM

"most important jobs at the time were MONOPOLISED BY WHITE OFFICIALS, and the British generally assumed that *** INDIANS COULD NOT BE GIVEN POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITY ***"

[2] AGAINST THE DRAIN OF WEALTH

"Since British officers were *** SENDING A MAJOR PART OF THEIR LARGE SALARIES HOME *** , Indianisation, it was hoped, would also *** REDUCE THE DRAIN OF WEALTH TO ENGLAND ***"

★ ★ The second reason is the one most students miss, and it is the more sophisticated point.

Indianisation was not merely a demand for dignity — **it was an economic argument**. Every British officer's salary remitted to England was capital leaving India. **Employ Indians and the money stays.**

🔗 **The drain argument traces back to the Diwani of 1765 (Ch.2)** and was systematised by **Dadabhai Naoroji** in *Poverty and Un-British Rule in India*.

★ ★ ★ Their economic critique — and why it matters

*"The early Congress also raised a number of **ECONOMIC ISSUES**. It declared that **BRITISH RULE HAD LED TO POVERTY AND FAMINES: increase in the LAND REVENUE had impoverished peasants and zamindars, and EXPORTS OF GRAINS TO EUROPE had created FOOD SHORTAGES.**"*

Their demands	Their resolutions
Reduction of revenue	On the SALT TAX
Cut in military expenditure	On the treatment of Indian labourers abroad
More funds for irrigation	On the sufferings of FOREST DWELLERS — <i>"caused by an interfering forest administration"</i>

★ ★ ★ **NCERT's own conclusion is important and worth quoting:** *"All this shows that **DESPITE BEING A BODY OF THE EDUCATED ELITE**, the Congress did **NOT** talk only on behalf of professional groups, zamindars or industrialists."*

🔗 **This is the corrective to the standard dismissal of the Moderates as a narrow elite club.** They raised the **salt tax, indentured labour abroad, and forest dwellers' grievances** — issues of the poorest. **Note the salt tax especially: the grievance Gandhi would choose forty-five years later was already on the Congress agenda in the 1880s.**

Their methods

*"The Moderate leaders wanted to **DEVELOP PUBLIC AWARENESS** about the **UNJUST NATURE** of British rule. They **published newspapers, wrote articles, and showed how British rule was leading to the ECONOMIC RUIN** of the country. They **criticised British rule in their speeches** and **sent representatives to different parts of the country to MOBILISE PUBLIC OPINION.**"*

★ ★ Their underlying assumption:

*"They felt that **the British had RESPECT FOR THE IDEALS OF FREEDOM AND JUSTICE**, and so they would **ACCEPT THE JUST DEMANDS** of Indians. What was necessary, therefore, was **to EXPRESS** these demands, and **MAKE THE GOVERNMENT AWARE** of the feelings of Indians."*

★★★ That assumption is the whole Moderate strategy, and its whole vulnerability. It rested on a belief that **the British were persuadable** — that once they understood, they would concede. **The next generation attacked precisely this belief.**

⚠️ And NCERT prints a critical voice from inside — Dinshaw Wacha to Naoroji, 1887:

*"Pherozeshah is nowadays too busy with his personal work... **They are already rich enough...** I wonder how if all remain busy in the pursuit of gold can the progress of the country be advanced?"* A frank admission that the early leaders were part-time politicians with lucrative practices.

5 ★★★ "Freedom Is Our Birthright" — the Radicals

Fact	Detail
★ When	"By the 1890s , many Indians began to raise questions about the political style of the Congress"
★★★ Who and where	In BENGAL, MAHARASHTRA and PUNJAB — ★ BEPIN CHANDRA PAL , ★ BAL GANGADHAR TILAK , ★ LALA LAJPAT RAI
★★★ Their charge	*"They criticised the Moderates for their 'POLITICS OF PRAYERS' "*
★★ Their emphasis	"The importance of SELF-RELIANCE and CONSTRUCTIVE WORK "
★★★ Their argument	" People must rely on THEIR OWN STRENGTH, not on the 'GOOD' INTENTIONS of the government; people must <i>fight for SWARAJ</i> "
★★★ Tilak's slogan	★ " FREEDOM IS MY BIRTHRIGHT AND I SHALL HAVE IT! "

🧠 "Lal, Bal, Pal" — Lala Lajpat Rai (Punjab), Bal Gangadhar Tilak (Maharashtra), Bipin Chandra Pal (Bengal). The classic trio, and their regions are asked.

★ Tilak's newspaper was **KESARI**, in **Marathi** — "*one of the strongest critics of British rule.*" **Lala Lajpat Rai** was also "*an active member of the **Arya Samaj***" (Ch.7 link).

🎯 The philosophical difference in one line: the Moderates believed **the British could be persuaded**; the Radicals believed **only Indian strength counted**. That is not a difference of temperament — it is a different theory of how power works.

6 ★★ ★ The Partition of Bengal, 1905, and Swadeshi

Fact	Detail
★★★ Who and when	Viceroy CURZON partitioned Bengal in 1905
Bengal then	"The BIGGEST PROVINCE of British India, including BIHAR and parts of ORISSA "
The official reason	"Reasons of ADMINISTRATIVE CONVENIENCE "
★★ NCERT's questioning of it	"But what did 'administrative convenience' mean? Whose 'convenience' did it represent? Clearly, it was closely tied to the interests of BRITISH OFFICIALS AND BUSINESSMEN "
★★★ The giveaway	*"Even so, INSTEAD OF REMOVING THE NON-BENGALI AREAS from the province, the government SEPARATED EAST BENGAL AND MERGED IT WITH ASSAM. "*
★★★ The real motives	"Perhaps the main British motives were to CURTAIN THE INFLUENCE OF BENGALI POLITICIANS and to SPLIT THE BENGALI PEOPLE "

★★★ The logical demolition in that "even so" sentence is worth reproducing in an answer. If the problem were genuinely that Bengal was too big and contained non-Bengali areas, the obvious remedy was to detach Bihar and Orissa. Instead the government split the Bengali-speaking population itself and attached half of it to Assam. The stated reason cannot explain the action taken.

★★★ The Swadeshi movement

*"The partition of Bengal **INFURIATED PEOPLE ALL OVER INDIA. ALL** sections of the Congress — the **MODERATES** and the **RADICALS**, as they may be called — **OPPOSED IT**. Large public meetings and demonstrations were organised and ★ **NOVEL METHODS OF MASS PROTEST** developed."*

Fact	Detail
★★ Its name	The ★ SWADESHI MOVEMENT , "strongest in Bengal but with echoes elsewhere too"
★★ In Andhra	"In deltaic ANDHRA it was known as the ★ VANDEMATARAM MOVEMENT "
★★★ What it sought	"To OPPOSE BRITISH RULE and encourage the ideas of ★ SELF-HELP, SWADESHI ENTERPRISE, NATIONAL EDUCATION, and USE OF INDIAN LANGUAGES "
★★★ The radicals' method	"To fight for swaraj, the radicals advocated ★ MASS MOBILISATION and BOYCOTT of British institutions and goods "
★★ And a new current	"Some individuals also began to suggest that ★ 'REVOLUTIONARY VIOLENCE' would be necessary to overthrow British rule"

★ **Revolutionary violence** = "the use of violence to make a radical change within society."

🎯 Swadeshi is the hinge of the movement's history. It is where nationalism moves from petitions to programmes — not just demanding, but **building** (swadeshi enterprise, national education) and **withholding** (boycott). Every later mass movement, including Gandhi's, uses this template.

7 ★★ ★ 1906–1916: League, Split and Pact

*** 1906 -- THE ALL INDIA MUSLIM LEAGUE ***

"A group of MUSLIM LANDLORDS AND NAWABS formed the All India Muslim League at *** DACCA in 1906. ***"

- "The League *** SUPPORTED the partition of Bengal ***"
- "It desired *** SEPARATE ELECTORATES for Muslims ***"

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*** 1909 -- SEPARATE ELECTORATES CONCEDED ***

"a demand conceded by the government in 1909. Some seats in the councils were now RESERVED FOR MUSLIMS who would be

*** ELECTED BY MUSLIM VOTERS. ***"

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*** THE CONSEQUENCE NCERT FLAGS: ***

"This *** TEMPTED POLITICIANS TO GATHER A FOLLOWING BY DISTRIBUTING FAVOURS TO THEIR OWN RELIGIOUS GROUPS. ***"

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*** 1907 -- THE CONGRESS SPLITS ***

"The Moderates were OPPOSED TO THE USE OF BOYCOTT. They felt that it involved the use of force."

"After the split, the Congress came to be DOMINATED BY THE MODERATES with *** TILAK'S FOLLOWERS FUNCTIONING FROM OUTSIDE. ***"

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*** DECEMBER 1915 -- THE TWO GROUPS REUNITED ***

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*** 1916 -- THE LUCKNOW PACT ***

"the Congress and the Muslim League signed the historic Lucknow Pact and decided to *** WORK TOGETHER FOR REPRESENTATIVE GOVERNMENT *** in the country."

★★★ The 1909 separate electorates deserve careful attention, because NCERT's comment is analytically precise.

Separate electorates meant a candidate in a reserved seat needed **only Muslim votes** — so there was **no electoral incentive to appeal across communities**, and every incentive to demonstrate loyalty to one's own. NCERT's phrasing — "*tempted politicians to gather a following by distributing favours to their own religious groups*" — describes **an institutional design shaping political behaviour**.

 **The constituency boundaries determined the strategy.** Change who can vote for you and you change who you must please. **Communal politics was not merely a sentiment; it was rewarded by the electoral architecture.**

 **This is essential background for the Partition section at the end of the chapter, and for any Mains answer on the growth of communalism.**

8 ★★ ★ The Growth of Mass Nationalism, and the First World War

"After 1919, the struggle against British rule gradually became a ★ **MASS MOVEMENT**, involving ★ **peasants, tribals, students and women in large numbers and occasionally factory workers as well.** ★ **Certain BUSINESS GROUPS too began to actively support the Congress in the 1920s.** Why was this so?"

★ ★ ★ The impact of the First World War — five effects

[1] *** TAXES AND PRICES ***

"It led to a **HUGE RISE IN THE DEFENCE EXPENDITURE** of the Government of India. The government in turn **INCREASED TAXES ON INDIVIDUAL INCOMES AND BUSINESS PROFITS.**"

"Increased military expenditure and the demands for war supplies led to a ***** SHARP RISE IN PRICES ***** which created **GREAT DIFFICULTIES FOR THE COMMON PEOPLE.**"

[2] *** BUSINESS PROFITED ***

"On the other hand, **BUSINESS GROUPS REAPED FABULOUS PROFITS** from the war."

"The war created a **DEMAND FOR INDUSTRIAL GOODS** (jute bags, cloth, rails) and caused a **DECLINE OF IMPORTS** from other countries. So ***** INDIAN INDUSTRIES EXPANDED ***** during the war, and Indian business groups began to **DEMAND GREATER OPPORTUNITIES** for development."

[3] *** FORCED RECRUITMENT ***

"The war led the British to **EXPAND THEIR ARMY.**"

***** VILLAGES WERE PRESSURISED TO SUPPLY SOLDIERS FOR AN ALIEN CAUSE. *****"

[4] *** RETURNING SOLDIERS ***

"Many returned after the war with an ***** UNDERSTANDING OF THE WAYS IN WHICH IMPERIALIST POWERS WERE EXPLOITING THE PEOPLES OF ASIA AND AFRICA ***** and with a **DESIRE TO OPPOSE COLONIAL RULE IN INDIA.**"

[5] *** THE RUSSIAN REVOLUTION, 1917 ***

"News about **PEASANTS' AND WORKERS' STRUGGLES** and ***** IDEAS OF SOCIALISM ***** circulated widely, **INSPIRING INDIAN NATIONALISTS.**"

★ ★ ★ This section answers the crucial question of why the movement became a **MASS** movement after 1919 — and the answer is that the war created grievances and capacities simultaneously.

Prices hit the poor; profits enriched Indian business (giving the Congress a funding base); forced recruitment angered villages; returning soldiers brought anti-imperial consciousness; and the Russian Revolution supplied a vocabulary of mass struggle. Every social group acquired a reason to join at the same moment.

🌀 Cite all five in a Mains answer on the transformation of the national movement.

9 ★ ★ ★ The Advent of Mahatma Gandhi

Fact	Detail
★ ★ ★ Arrival	"Gandhiji, aged 46 , arrived in India in ★ 1915 from SOUTH AFRICA "
★ ★ His standing	"Having led Indians in that country in NON-VIOLENT MARCHES against RACIST RESTRICTIONS , he was already a respected leader, KNOWN INTERNATIONALLY "
★ ★ ★ What South Africa gave him	"His South African campaigns had brought him in contact with VARIOUS TYPES OF INDIANS: Hindus, Muslims, Parsis and Christians; Gujaratis, Tamils and north Indians; and upper-class merchants, lawyers and WORKERS "
★ ★ His first year	"Spent his first year in India TRAVELLING THROUGHOUT THE COUNTRY, UNDERSTANDING THE PEOPLE, their needs and the overall situation "
★ ★ ★ First interventions	★ CHAMPARAN, KHEDA and AHMEDABAD — "where he came into contact with RAJENDRA PRASAD and VALLABHBHAI PATEL ". ★ "In Ahmedabad, he led a successful MILLWORKERS' STRIKE in 1918 "

★★ The South Africa point explains Gandhi's later effectiveness better than anything else. Before he ever led an Indian campaign, he had already organised **across religion, region and class** — the exact coalition Indian nationalism needed and had not achieved. **He arrived with the skill already learned.**

★ Also note the 1895 Natal Congress, which he founded with other Indians in Durban **to fight racial discrimination.**

🔗 CHAMPARAN is Chapter 3's indigo story — the planters had moved from Bengal to Bihar, and a peasant from Bihar persuaded Gandhi to come. Cross-reference it.

10 ★★ ★ The Rowlatt Satyagraha and Jallianwala Bagh, 1919

Fact	Detail
★★★ The Act	"The ROWLATT ACT that the British had just passed... ★ curbed FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS such as the FREEDOM OF EXPRESSION and STRENGTHENED POLICE POWERS "
★★ Who objected	★ "Mahatma Gandhi, MOHAMMAD ALI JINNAH and others felt that the government had no right to restrict people's basic freedoms . They criticised the Act as ★ 'DEVILISH' and TYRANNICAL "
★★★ The call	*"Gandhiji asked the Indian people to observe ★ 6 APRIL 1919 as a day of non-violent opposition , as a day of ★ 'HUMILIATION AND PRAYER' and HARTAL (strike) . SATYAGRAHA SABHAS were set up"*
★★★ Its significance	"The Rowlatt Satyagraha turned out to be ★ THE FIRST ALL-INDIA STRUGGLE against the British government — although it was largely restricted to CITIES "
★★★ Jallianwala Bagh	*"The JALLIANWALA BAGH atrocities , inflicted by ★ GENERAL DYER in AMRITSAR on ★ BAISAKHI DAY (13 APRIL) , were a part of this repression"*
★★★ Tagore's response	"On learning about the massacre, ★ RABINDRANATH TAGORE expressed the pain and anger of the country by RENOUNCING HIS KNIGHTHOOD "

★ **Knighthood** = "an honour granted by the British Crown for exceptional personal achievement or public service."

★★ Note that Jinnah opposed the Rowlatt Act alongside Gandhi. In 1919 they were on the same side — a fact worth carrying into the Partition section, where NCERT notes Jinnah was "an ambassador of Hindu-Muslim unity until 1920." **The eventual division was not inevitable from the start.**

★★ And note the Hindu-Muslim unity theme: "During the Rowlatt Satyagraha, the participants tried to ensure that **Hindus and Muslims were UNITED in the fight**. This was also the call of Mahatma Gandhi, **who always saw India as a land of ALL the people who lived in the country.**"

The Khilafat cause

Fact	Detail
★ ★ The issue	"In 1920 , the British imposed a HARSH TREATY on the TURKISH SULTAN or KHALIFA "
★ The feeling	"People were furious about this as they had been about the Jallianwala massacre "
★ ★ The specific concern	"Indian Muslims were keen that the Khalifa be allowed to RETAIN CONTROL OVER MUSLIM SACRED PLACES in the erstwhile OTTOMAN EMPIRE "
★ ★ ★ The leaders	★ MOHAMMAD ALI and SHAUKAT ALI — "now wished to initiate a full-fledged NON-COOPERATION MOVEMENT "
★ ★ ★ Gandhi's three demands	"Gandhiji supported their call and urged the Congress to campaign against ★ (1) ' PUNJAB WRONGS ' (the Jallianwala massacre), (2) the KHILAFAT WRONG , and (3) demand SWARAJ "

★ ★ ★ The three-part demand is asked directly, and the political construction is worth admiring: Gandhi combined a Punjabi/Hindu-Sikh grievance, a pan-Islamic grievance, and a universal national demand into a single platform. That is how a mass movement across communities was built.

★ ★ What Non-Cooperation looked like

Action
★ "Thousands of STUDENTS left government-controlled schools and colleges"
★ ★ "Many LAWYERS such as MOTILAL NEHRU , C. R. DAS , C. RAJAGOPALACHARI and ASAF ALI gave up their practices"
★ " British TITLES were surrendered and LEGISLATURES BOYCOTTED "
★ ★ "People lit PUBLIC BONFIRES OF FOREIGN CLOTH . The imports of foreign cloth FELL DRASTICALLY between 1920 and 1922"

★ * "But all this was merely **THE TIP OF THE ICEBERG**. Large parts of the country were on the brink of a **FORMIDABLE REVOLT**."*

★ ★ ★ People's initiatives — the crucial section

* "In many cases, people resisted British rule non-violently. In others, ★ ★ different classes and groups, **INTERPRETING GANDHIJI'S CALL IN THEIR OWN MANNER**, protested in ways that were **NOT IN ACCORDANCE WITH HIS IDEAS**. In either case, ★ people **LINKED THEIR MOVEMENTS TO LOCAL GRIEVANCES**."*

★ ★ ★ The regional forms — a favourite Mains question ("discuss the various forms the Non-Cooperation Movement took in different parts of India"):

Region	Form it took
★ ★ KHEDA, Gujarat	PATIDAR peasants organised non-violent campaigns against the high land revenue demand
★ Coastal ANDHRA and interior TAMIL NADU	LIQUOR SHOPS were PICKETED
★ ★ ★ GUNTUR district, Andhra	Tribals and poor peasants staged ★ "FOREST SATYAGRAHAS", " <i>sometimes sending their cattle into forests without paying grazing fee</i> " — protesting the colonial restriction of forest use. ★ " <i>They believed that Gandhiji would get their taxes reduced and have the forest regulations abolished</i> "; in many forest villages peasants proclaimed swaraj and believed ★ "GANDHI RAJ" was about to be established
★ ★ SIND	Muslim traders and peasants were very enthusiastic about the Khilafat call
★ ★ BENGAL	"The <i>Khilafat–Non-Cooperation alliance</i> gave ENORMOUS COMMUNAL UNITY AND STRENGTH to the national movement"
★ ★ ★ PUNJAB	The ★ AKALI AGITATION of the Sikhs sought to remove corrupt MAHANTS — supported by the British — from their GURDWARAS. " <i>This movement got closely identified with the Non-Cooperation Movement</i> "
★ ★ ★ ASSAM	★ TEA GARDEN LABOURERS, shouting ★ "GANDHI MAHARAJ KI JAI", demanded a big increase in their wages and left the British-owned plantations declaring they were following Gandhiji's wish. ★ *Interestingly, in the Assamese VAISHNAVA SONGS of the period, the reference to KRISHNA was substituted by 'GANDHI RAJA'***

★ **Mahants** = "religious functionaries of Sikh gurdwaras." ★ **Picket** = "people protesting outside a building or shop to prevent others from entering."

★ ★ ★ "The people's Mahatma"

"Sometimes people thought of Gandhiji as a kind of MESSIAH, as someone who could help them overcome their misery and poverty. ★ ★ Gandhiji wished to build CLASS UNITY, NOT CLASS CONFLICT, yet PEASANTS could imagine that he would help them in their fight against ZAMINDARS, and AGRICULTURAL LABOURERS believed he would PROVIDE THEM LAND."

★ *"*At times, ordinary people CREDITED GANDHIJI WITH THEIR OWN ACHIEVEMENTS.*"* — the peasants of PRATAPGARH in the United Provinces "*managed to stop ILLEGAL EVICTION of tenants; but they felt it was GANDHIJI who had won this demand for them.*"

★ "*At other times, USING GANDHIJI'S NAME, tribals and peasants undertook actions that DID NOT CONFORM TO GANDHIAN IDEALS.*"

★ ★ ★ And the CID report from Allahabad, January 1921 — one of the best sources in the book:

*"The CURRENCY which Mr. Gandhi's name has acquired even in the remotest villages is ASTONISHING. NO ONE SEEMS TO KNOW QUITE WHO OR WHAT HE IS, but it is an accepted fact that WHAT HE SAYS IS SO, AND WHAT HE ORDERS MUST BE DONE. He is a Mahatma or sadhu, a Pundit, a Brahmin who lives at Allahabad, even a DEOTA... the real power of his name is to be traced back to the idea that it was he who got *bedakhli* [illegal eviction] stopped in Pratapgarh... ★ ★ as a general rule, GANDHI IS NOT THOUGHT OF AS BEING ANTAGONISTIC TO GOVERNMENT, BUT ONLY TO THE ZAMINDARS... 'WE ARE FOR GANDHIJI AND THE SARKAR.'"*

★★★ NCERT's activity asks exactly the right question — why did people think Gandhi was opposed to zamindars but not to the government? — and the answer is genuinely illuminating.

People fitted Gandhi into the grievance they actually had. Their oppressor was the **zamindar** they saw every day, not the distant Sarkar. So they read him as **an ally against the landlord**, and there was no contradiction in being "for Gandhiji and the Sarkar."

★★ The deeper point for a Mains answer: a mass movement's leader **cannot control what his name is made to mean**. Gandhi's authority in the villages rested on **a version of Gandhi that the villagers had constructed** — and that gap between the leader's programme and the people's interpretation is what makes mass movements powerful **and uncontrollable**. Chauri Chaura is that gap becoming visible.

1 2 ★★★ 1922–1929

★★★ Chauri Chaura

Fact	Detail
★★★ When and what	"He abruptly CALLED OFF the Non-Cooperation Movement when in ★ FEBRUARY 1922, a crowd of peasants SET FIRE TO A POLICE STATION at CHAURI CHAURA . ★ TWENTY-TWO POLICEMEN were killed on that day"
★★ The provocation	★ "The peasants were provoked because THE POLICE HAD FIRED ON THEIR PEACEFUL DEMONSTRATION "
Why he stopped	"Mahatma Gandhi was against violent movements "

★★ NCERT includes the provocation, and you should too. The crowd was not spontaneously violent — **the police had fired on a peaceful demonstration first**. Gandhi withdrew the movement anyway, which is precisely what made the decision so controversial among his own colleagues. **State both facts and the decision becomes genuinely debatable rather than simply noble.**

The two paths after 1922

Path	Who	What
★★ Constructive work	Gandhiji's followers	"The Congress must undertake CONSTRUCTIVE WORK IN THE RURAL AREAS " — ★ **Through sincere social work in villages in the mid-1920s , the Gandhians were able to EXTEND THEIR SUPPORT BASE . This proved to be VERY USEFUL IN LAUNCHING THE CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE MOVEMENT IN 1930 .**
★★ Council entry	★ CHITTA RANJAN DAS and MOTILAL NEHRU	"The party should FIGHT ELECTIONS TO THE COUNCILS and ENTER THEM in order to INFLUENCE GOVERNMENT POLICIES "

🌀 The link NCERT draws is important: the quiet village work of the mid-1920s **built the base that made 1930 possible**. Movements are not spontaneous; **the interval between them is when the organisation is built**.

★★ Other developments of the mid-1920s

*"Two important developments of the mid-1920s were the formation of the ★ **RASHTRIYA SWAYAMSEVAK SANGH (RSS)**, a Hindu organisation, and the ★ **COMMUNIST PARTY OF INDIA**. These parties have held very different ideas about the kind of country India should be. ★ The revolutionary nationalist **BHAGAT SINGH** too was active in this period."*

★★★ The revolutionaries

Fact	Detail
★★ Who	BHAGAT SINGH, CHANDRA SHEKHAR AZAD, SUKHDEV and others
★★ Their aim	<i>"To fight against the colonial rule AND the rich exploiting classes through a REVOLUTION OF WORKERS AND PEASANTS"</i>
★★★ What they founded	The ★ HINDUSTAN SOCIALIST REPUBLICAN ASSOCIATION (HSRA) in ★ 1928 at FEROZESHAH KOTLA, DELHI
★★ 17 December 1928	Bhagat Singh, Azad and Rajguru assassinated SAUNDERS , <i>"a police officer involved in the lathi-charge that had caused the death of LALA LAJPAT RAI"</i>
★★★ 8 April 1929	Bhagat Singh and B. K. DUTT threw a bomb in the CENTRAL LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY . ★ <i>""The aim, as their leaflet explained, was NOT TO KILL but 'TO MAKE THE DEAF HEAR', and to remind the foreign government of its callous exploitation"</i> *
★★★ 23 March 1931	Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and Rajguru were EXECUTED . ★ <i>"Bhagat Singh's age at that time was only 23"</i>
★ The slogan	★ "INQILAB ZINDABAD!"

★★ **Note the two-part aim: against colonial rule AND the rich exploiting classes.** The HSRA was **socialist**, not merely nationalist — the "S" in its name matters. **And the bomb was explicitly designed not to kill** but to force attention. That intent is quoted from their own leaflet and is frequently asked.

★★ Simon and Purna Swaraj

Fact	Detail
★★★ 1927	*"The British government decided to send a commission headed by ★ LORD SIMON to decide India's political future. ★ The Commission had NO INDIAN REPRESENTATIVE . The decision created an outrage in India . ALL political groups decided to BOYCOTT the Commission . When it arrived, it was met with demonstrations with banners saying ★ 'SIMON GO BACK' "*
★★★ 1929	<i>"The decade closed with the Congress resolving to fight for ★ PURNA SWARAJ (complete independence) in 1929 under the presidency of ★ JAWAHARLAL NEHRU"</i>
★★★ 26 January 1930	<i>"Consequently, ★ 'INDEPENDENCE DAY' was observed on 26 JANUARY 1930 all over the country"</i>

🔗 **26 January was chosen as Republic Day in 1950 precisely to honour this date.** A neat Polity crossover.

1 3 ★★★ The March to Dandi, 1930

*"Purna Swaraj would never come on its own. **IT HAD TO BE FOUGHT FOR.**"*

Fact	Detail
★★ The law	"According to this law, the state had a MONOPOLY on the MANUFACTURE AND SALE OF SALT "
★★ The argument	"Gandhi and other nationalists reasoned that it was SINFUL TO TAX SALT since it is such an ESSENTIAL ITEM OF OUR FOOD "
★★★ Why salt was chosen	★ "The Salt March RELATED THE GENERAL DESIRE OF FREEDOM TO A SPECIFIC GRIEVANCE SHARED BY EVERYBODY , and thus ★ DID NOT DIVIDE THE RICH AND THE POOR "
★★★ The march	"Gandhiji and his followers marched for over ★ 240 MILES from SABARMATI to the coastal town of ★ DANDI , where they broke the government law by GATHERING NATURAL SALT found on the seashore, and BOILING SEA WATER to produce salt "
★★ The date	★ 6 April 1930

★★★ NCERT's own question — "why did Gandhiji choose to break the salt law?" — is answered in that one sentence, and it is the best short statement of Gandhi's political genius:

Salt was universal. Every Indian used it; the poorest were hit hardest by the tax; and **no class or community could object to the cause.** A campaign about land revenue would have divided peasant from landlord; a campaign about legislative seats would have excluded the illiterate. **Salt included everyone.**

🔗 **Recall Class 8 Ch.5's Khurda case study** — the **salt monopoly** deprived Orissa's traditional salt makers and raised prices, and was one of the grievances behind the **1817 uprising**. The salt grievance was a **century old** when Gandhi picked it up. **And the Moderates had passed resolutions on the salt tax in the 1880s.** Gandhi did not invent the issue — **he found the one everybody already agreed on.**

★★ The response:

"Peasants, tribals and women participated in large numbers. ★ A BUSINESS FEDERATION published a pamphlet on the salt issue. The government tried to **crush the movement through BRUTAL ACTION against peaceful satyagrahis. THOUSANDS were sent to jail.**"*

1 4 ★★★ Women in the Freedom Struggle

"Women from diverse backgrounds participated. Young and old, single and married, they came from RURAL AND URBAN areas, from both CONSERVATIVE AND LIBERAL homes. ★ Both British officials AND Indian nationalists felt that women's participation gave the national struggle an IMMENSE FORCE."*

★★ What participation meant for women:

"Participation in the freedom movement ★ BROUGHT WOMEN OUT OF THEIR HOMES. It gave them a place in the PROFESSIONS, in the GOVERNANCE OF INDIA, and it could PAVE THE WAY FOR EQUALITY WITH MEN."*

★ ★ ★ Ambabai of Karnataka — the case study

Fact	Detail
Her life	★ Married at TWELVE, ★ widowed at SIXTEEN
Her activity	★ Picketed foreign cloth and liquor shops in UDIPI
The consequences	★ Arrested, served a sentence, and was REARRESTED
Between prison terms	"She <i>made speeches, taught SPINNING, and organised</i> ★ PRABHAT PHERIS"
★ ★ ★ Her own verdict	"Ambabai regarded these as ★ THE HAPPIEST DAYS OF HER LIFE because they gave it a NEW PURPOSE AND COMMITMENT"

★ ★ ★ Ambabai is the single best example in the book for a GS1 answer on women and the national movement, and it must be told with the biography attached.

A girl **married at twelve and widowed at sixteen** — condemned by the customs of Chapter 7 to a life of invisibility — found in the national movement **a public role, a purpose, and by her own account the happiest days of her life.** The freedom struggle was, for many women, personal liberation before it was national liberation.

⚠ ★ ★ ★ And the resistance they faced from their own side

*"Women, however, **HAD TO FIGHT FOR THEIR RIGHT TO PARTICIPATE IN THE MOVEMENT.** ★ ★ During the Salt Satyagraha, for instance, **EVEN MAHATMA GANDHI WAS INITIALLY OPPOSED TO WOMEN'S PARTICIPATION.** ★ SAROJINI NAIDU **HAD TO PERSUADE HIM** to allow women to join the movement."*

★ ★ ★ NCERT states this plainly and so should you. It is a fact that complicates the standard hagiography and **strengthens** an answer rather than weakening it. **Women's participation was not granted; it was won — and won against the leadership of the movement itself.**

★ **Sarojini Naidu:** active since the early 1920s, "*a significant leader of the Dandi March*", and ★ **the FIRST INDIAN WOMAN to become PRESIDENT OF THE INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS (1925).**

🔗 This is the same deferral pattern as Chapter 7 — women told to wait, told to concentrate on the national struggle. **Here they simply refused to wait.**

1 5 ★ ★ 1935–1939: Provincial Autonomy and the War

Fact	Detail
★ ★ ★ 1935	"The combined struggles of the Indian people bore fruit when the ★ GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ACT OF 1935 prescribed PROVINCIAL AUTONOMY "
★ ★ ★ 1937	"The government announced elections to the PROVINCIAL LEGISLATURES in 1937. ★ The Congress formed governments in 7 OUT OF 11 PROVINCES "
★ ★ ★ September 1939	"After two years of Congress rule in the provinces, the SECOND WORLD WAR broke out "
★ ★ ★ The Congress position	★ "Critical of HITLER, Congress leaders were READY TO SUPPORT THE BRITISH WAR EFFORT. BUT IN RETURN THEY WANTED THAT INDIA BE GRANTED INDEPENDENCE AFTER THE WAR. The British REFUSED to concede the demand. THE CONGRESS MINISTRIES RESIGNED IN PROTEST." *

★ **Provincial autonomy** = "capacity of the provinces to make relatively independent decisions while remaining within a federation."

🇮🇳 The 1939 offer is important and often forgotten: the Congress was willing to fight Hitler in exchange for a promise of independence. The British refusal is what produced the resignations, and ultimately Quit India. It also created the vacuum in which the Muslim League grew — see below.

1 6 ★ ★ ★ Quit India, 1942

Fact	Detail
★ ★ When and why	"Mahatma Gandhi decided to initiate a new phase of movement against the British IN THE MIDDLE OF THE SECOND WORLD WAR "
★ ★ ★ The demand	" The British must QUIT INDIA IMMEDIATELY "
★ ★ ★ The call to the people	★ "DO OR DIE" in your effort to fight the British — ★ "BUT YOU MUST FIGHT NON-VIOLENTLY"
★ ★ The leaders	" Gandhiji and other leaders were JAILED AT ONCE — BUT THE MOVEMENT SPREAD "
★ ★ ★ Who joined	★ "It specially attracted PEASANTS and the YOUTH who GAVE UP THEIR STUDIES to join it "
★ ★ ★ What happened	★ "COMMUNICATIONS AND SYMBOLS OF STATE AUTHORITY were ATTACKED all over the country. IN MANY AREAS THE PEOPLE SET UP THEIR OWN GOVERNMENTS." *
★ ★ ★ The repression	*"The first response of the British was SEVERE REPRESSION . By the end of 1943, ★ OVER 90,000 PEOPLE WERE ARRESTED , and around ★ 1,000 KILLED in police firing. ★ In many areas, ORDERS WERE GIVEN TO MACHINE-GUN CROWDS FROM AIRPLANES. "*
★ ★ ★ The verdict	★ "THE REBELLION, HOWEVER, ULTIMATELY BROUGHT THE RAJ TO ITS KNEES."

★ ★ A regional voice — Orissa, from Baji Mohammed, President of the Nabrangpur Congress:

*"On **25 August 1942...** nineteen people died on the spot in police firing at **PAPARANDI in NABARANGPUR**. Many died thereafter from their wounds. **Over 300 were injured. More than a thousand were jailed in Koraput district.** Several were shot or executed. ★ **VEER LAKHAN NAYAK** (a legendary tribal leader who defied the British) **was hanged.**"*

★ *"Nayak was **not worried about being executed, only sad that he would not live to see freedom's dawn.**"* Baji Mohammad himself "**mobilised 20,000 people to join the national struggle... and served long jail terms.**"

★ ★ ★ "**In many areas the people set up their own governments**" is the most significant sentence about Quit India. It was not merely a protest — in places it was **a collapse of British authority and its replacement by parallel government** (Satara, Ballia, Tamluk). **That is why NCERT says it brought the Raj to its knees**, despite being crushed militarily.

★★★★ Bose and the INA

Fact	Detail
★★ Who	SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE — "a RADICAL NATIONALIST , with SOCIALIST LEANINGS "
★★★★ His difference with Gandhi	★ "Bose DID NOT SHARE GANDHIJI'S IDEAL OF AHIMSA , though he RESPECTED HIM AS THE 'FATHER OF THE NATION' "
★★★★ His escape	"In ★ JANUARY 1941 , he secretly left his CALCUTTA home , went to SINGAPORE, VIA GERMANY "
★★★★ What he raised	The ★ AZAD HIND FAUJ or INDIAN NATIONAL ARMY (INA)
★★★★ The campaign	"To free India from British control, in ★ 1944 the INA tried to ENTER INDIA through ★ IMPHAL and KOHIMA — but the campaign FAILED "
★★★★ The trials	★ "The INA members were imprisoned and tried. ★ People across the country, FROM ALL WALKS OF LIFE, participated in the movement AGAINST THE INA TRIALS."

★★ **The INA trials matter more than the INA campaign.** The military effort failed at Imphal and Kohima — but **the trials at the Red Fort produced nationwide agitation across every community**, and shook British confidence in the loyalty of the Indian army. **That, not the fighting, is the INA's historical significance.**

1 7 ★★★★★ Towards Independence and Partition

★★★★ Why the League moved to a separate demand — five reasons

*** 1940 -- THE MUSLIM LEAGUE RESOLUTION ***
 "the Muslim League had moved a resolution demanding
 *** 'INDEPENDENT STATES' for Muslims in the NORTH-WESTERN and
 EASTERN areas of the country. ***
 *** THE RESOLUTION DID NOT MENTION PARTITION OR PAKISTAN. ***"

WHY DID THE LEAGUE ASK FOR THIS? -- NCERT's reasons:

[1] "From the LATE 1930s, the League began viewing the Muslims as a *** SEPARATE 'NATION' *** from the Hindus."

[2] "it may have been influenced by the HISTORY OF TENSION between some Hindu and Muslim groups in the *** 1920s and 1930s. ***"

[3] *** MORE IMPORTANTLY -- THE 1937 ELECTIONS ***
 "the provincial elections of 1937 seemed to have CONVINCED THE LEAGUE THAT *** MUSLIMS WERE A MINORITY, and they would ALWAYS HAVE TO PLAY SECOND FIDDLE IN ANY DEMOCRATIC STRUCTURE. ***
 It feared that *** MUSLIMS MAY EVEN GO UNREPRESENTED. ***"

[4] "The Congress's *** REJECTION of the League's desire to form a JOINT CONGRESS-LEAGUE GOVERNMENT IN THE UNITED PROVINCES in 1937 *** also ANNOYED the League."

[5] *** "The Congress's FAILURE TO MOBILISE THE MUSLIM MASSES in the 1930s ALLOWED THE LEAGUE TO WIDEN ITS SOCIAL SUPPORT." ***
 "It sought to enlarge its support in the early 1940s
 *** WHEN MOST CONGRESS LEADERS WERE IN JAIL. ***"

★ ★ ★ This is NCERT's answer to "discuss those developments of the 1937–47 period that led to the creation of Pakistan", and it is notable for how much responsibility it assigns to Congress decisions.

Reasons [4] and [5] are Congress failures, stated plainly: refusing a coalition in the UP, and failing to mobilise Muslim masses. Reason [3] is structural — under a democratic franchise a permanent minority fears permanent subordination.

★ And note [5]'s timing: the League grew precisely when Congress leaders were in jail after Quit India. The 1942 movement, which brought the Raj to its knees, also left the field open to the League for three critical years. That is a genuinely difficult and important point, and it makes a strong Mains answer.

The final sequence

Year	Event
★ ★ End of 1945	*"The British opened negotiations between the Congress, the League and themselves for the independence of India. ★ The talks FAILED because the LEAGUE SAW ITSELF AS THE SOLE SPOKESPERSON OF INDIA'S MUSLIMS. The Congress could not accept this claim since A LARGE NUMBER OF MUSLIMS STILL SUPPORTED IT."*
★ ★ ★ 1946 elections	*"The Congress did well in the 'GENERAL' constituencies but ★ the League's success in the SEATS RESERVED FOR MUSLIMS was SPECTACULAR. It persisted with its demand for 'Pakistan'."*
★ ★ ★ March 1946	*"The British cabinet sent a ★ THREE-MEMBER MISSION to DELHI to examine this demand... ★ This mission suggested that INDIA SHOULD REMAIN UNITED and constitute itself as a LOOSE CONFEDERATION with SOME AUTONOMY FOR MUSLIM-MAJORITY AREAS. But it COULD NOT GET THE CONGRESS AND THE MUSLIM LEAGUE TO AGREE to specific details. ★ PARTITION NOW BECAME MORE OR LESS INEVITABLE."*
★ ★ ★ 16 August 1946	*"After the failure of the Cabinet Mission, the Muslim League decided on mass agitation for winning its Pakistan demand. It announced ★ 16 AUGUST 1946 as 'DIRECT ACTION DAY'. On this day RIOTS BROKE OUT IN CALCUTTA, lasting several days and resulting in the death of THOUSANDS of people."*
★ ★ ★ March 1947	*"Violence spread to different parts of NORTHERN INDIA."*

★ "General" constituencies = "election districts with **no reservations** for any religious or other community."

★ ★ ★ The human cost

"Many HUNDRED THOUSAND people were KILLED and NUMEROUS WOMEN had to face UNTOLD BRUTALITIES during the Partition. MILLIONS of people were FORCED TO FLEE THEIR HOMES. Torn asunder from their homelands, they were REDUCED TO BEING REFUGEES IN ALIEN LANDS."

★ ★ ★ *"Partition also meant that India changed, many of its cities changed, and a new country — Pakistan — was born. ★ ★ SO, THE JOY OF OUR COUNTRY'S INDEPENDENCE FROM BRITISH RULE CAME MIXED WITH THE PAIN AND VIOLENCE OF PARTITION."*

★ ★ The leaders NCERT profiles — know these

Leader	Key detail
★ ★ Jawaharlal Nehru	"Gandhiji's disciple, a Congress Socialist , and an internationalist "; a leading architect of the movement and of free India's economy and polity
★ ★ MAULANA AZAD	★ "Born in MECCA to a Bengali father and an Arab mother "; a scholar of Islam and exponent of ★ WAHADAT-I-DEEN , the essential ONENESS OF ALL RELIGIONS ; ★ a staunch advocate of Hindu-Muslim unity , OPPOSED TO JINNAH'S TWO-NATION THEORY
★ ★ C. RAJAGOPALACHARI ("Rajaji")	"Leader of the Salt Satyagraha in the south "; member of the Interim Government of 1946 ; ★ free India's FIRST INDIAN GOVERNOR-GENERAL
★ ★ Sardar VALLABHBHAI PATEL	"Hailed from an impoverished peasant-proprietor family of NADIAD, Gujarat "; a foremost organiser from 1918; ★ President of the Congress in 1931 ; important in the 1945–47 negotiations
★ ★ ★ MOHAMMAD ALI JINNAH	★ "An AMBASSADOR OF HINDU-MUSLIM UNITY UNTIL 1920 , [he] played an important role in the making of the LUCKNOW PACT . He REORGANISED THE MUSLIM LEAGUE AFTER 1934 , and became the major spokesperson for the demand for Pakistan "
★ ★ ★ KHAN ABDUL GHAFFAR KHAN	★ "Also known as BADSHAH KHAN ", the Pashtun leader from the North West Frontier Province ; ★ founder of the KHUDAI KHIDMATGARS , a powerful NON-VIOLENT movement among the Pathans ; ★ strongly opposed to the Partition of India — he criticised his Congress colleagues for agreeing to the 1947 division

★ ★ ★ Two of these profiles carry real analytical weight.

Jinnah "an ambassador of Hindu-Muslim unity until 1920" — the architect of Pakistan began as the architect of the **Lucknow Pact**. NCERT is refusing a caricature, and so should you. **Positions changed; they were not fixed from the start.**

Badshah Khan opposed Partition and criticised his own Congress colleagues for accepting it — a Muslim Pashtun leader of a **non-violent** mass movement who felt abandoned in 1947. **He is the single best counter-example to any claim that the demand for Pakistan represented all Indian Muslims.**

Prelims

Topic	The exact thing to know
Early associations ★ ★	Poona Sarvajanik Sabha, Indian Association, Madras Mahajan Sabha, Bombay Presidency Association
Arms Act / Vernacular Press Act ★ ★ ★	Both 1878
Ilbert Bill ★ ★ ★	1883 ; trial of Europeans by Indian judges; withdrawn after white opposition
Congress founded ★ ★ ★	Bombay, December 1885, 72 delegates
Early leaders ★ ★	Naoroji, Pherozeshah Mehta, Badruddin Tyabji, W. C. Bonnerji, Surendranath Banerji, R. C. Dutt, S. Subramania Iyer; A. O. Hume
Naoroji ★ ★	<i>Poverty and Un-British Rule in India</i> ; member of the British Parliament
Moderate demands ★ ★ ★	Representative councils; civil service exams in India ; separation of judiciary and executive ; repeal of the Arms Act ; freedom of speech
Moderate economics ★ ★	Salt tax, Indian labourers abroad, forest dwellers ; reduce revenue, cut military spending, fund irrigation
Radicals ★ ★ ★	Lala Lajpat Rai (Punjab), Tilak (Maharashtra), Bipin Chandra Pal (Bengal) ; "politics of prayers" ; "Freedom is my birthright" ; Tilak's paper <i>Kesari</i>
Partition of Bengal ★ ★ ★	Curzon, 1905 ; East Bengal merged with Assam
Swadeshi ★ ★ ★	Self-help, swadeshi enterprise, national education , Indian languages; boycott ; in Andhra the Vandemataram Movement
Muslim League ★ ★ ★	Dacca, 1906 ; supported the partition of Bengal; wanted separate electorates
Separate electorates ★ ★ ★	Conceded 1909
Congress split ★ ★ ★	1907 ; reunited December 1915
Lucknow Pact ★ ★ ★	1916
WWI effects ★ ★ ★	Higher taxes and prices; business profits ; forced recruitment ; returning soldiers; Russian Revolution 1917
Gandhi's arrival ★ ★ ★	1915 , aged 46 , from South Africa ; Natal Congress 1895
First campaigns ★ ★ ★	Champaran, Kheda, Ahmedabad ; Ahmedabad millworkers' strike 1918 ; met Rajendra Prasad and Vallabhbhai Patel
Rowlatt ★ ★ ★	6 April 1919 hartal; Jinnah also opposed the Act; first all-India struggle , largely urban
Jallianwala Bagh ★ ★ ★	General Dyer, Amritsar, Baisakhi, 13 April 1919 ; Tagore renounced his knighthood
Khilafat ★ ★ ★	Mohammad Ali and Shaukat Ali ; the three demands — Punjab wrongs, Khilafat wrong, swaraj
Non-Cooperation forms ★ ★ ★	Kheda Patidars, Andhra/Tamil Nadu liquor picketing, Guntur forest satyagrahas, Sind, Bengal, Punjab Akali agitation vs mahants, Assam tea labourers "Gandhi Maharaj ki Jai"

Topic	The exact thing to know
Chauri Chaura ★ ★ ★	February 1922; 22 policemen killed ; police had fired on a peaceful demonstration first
Mid-1920s ★ ★	RSS and the Communist Party of India ; C. R. Das and Motilal Nehru favoured council entry
HSRA ★ ★ ★	1928, Ferozeshah Kotla, Delhi; Saunders killed 17 December 1928; Assembly bomb 8 April 1929 ("to make the deaf hear"); executed 23 March 1931 , Bhagat Singh aged 23
Simon Commission ★ ★ ★	1927; no Indian member; "Simon Go Back"
Purna Swaraj ★ ★ ★	1929 , under Jawaharlal Nehru ; Independence Day 26 January 1930
Dandi ★ ★ ★	Over 240 miles, Sabarmati to Dandi, 6 April 1930
Ambabai ★ ★	Married at 12 , widowed at 16 ; picketed at Udipi ; prabhat pheris
Sarojini Naidu ★ ★ ★	First Indian woman President of the Congress, 1925; persuaded Gandhi to allow women in the Salt Satyagraha
Gol Act 1935 / 1937 ★ ★ ★	Provincial autonomy ; Congress formed governments in 7 of 11 provinces
1939 ★ ★	Congress ministries resigned when Britain refused independence after the war
Quit India ★ ★ ★	1942; "do or die" but non-violently; over 90,000 arrested by end-1943, ~1,000 killed; machine-gunning from aircraft; people set up their own governments
Lakhan Nayak ★	Tribal leader hanged; Paparandi, Nabarangpur, 25 August 1942
Bose and INA ★ ★ ★	Left Calcutta January 1941 , via Germany to Singapore ; Azad Hind Fauj ; Imphal and Kohima, 1944 ; the INA trials
League resolution ★ ★ ★	1940; "Independent States" in the north-west and east; ★ did NOT mention Partition or Pakistan
1946 ★ ★ ★	Cabinet Mission (three members, March 1946) proposed a united, loose confederation; Direct Action Day, 16 August 1946 , riots in Calcutta
Leaders ★ ★	Azad (born in Mecca, wahadat-i-deen , opposed the two-nation theory); Rajaji (first Indian Governor-General); Patel (Nadiad , Congress President 1931); Jinnah (ambassador of Hindu-Muslim unity until 1920); Badshah Khan (Khudai Khidmatgars , opposed Partition)

Traps:

- **"The Muslim League's 1940 resolution demanded Pakistan" → FALSE.** It demanded **"Independent States"** and **did not mention Partition or Pakistan** (*NCERT asks this directly*)
- **"The Ilbert Bill was passed" → FALSE.** It was **withdrawn** after white opposition
- **"The Muslim League opposed the partition of Bengal" → FALSE.** It **supported** it
- **"Separate electorates were granted in 1906" → FALSE.** The League was founded in **1906**; separate electorates came in **1909**
- **"Gandhi welcomed women into the Salt Satyagraha from the start" → FALSE.** He was **initially opposed**; **Sarojini Naidu** persuaded him
- **"Bhagat Singh's Assembly bomb was intended to kill" → FALSE.** Their leaflet said it was **"to make the deaf hear"**
- **"The Congress refused to support the British in WWII on principle" → Incomplete.** They were **ready to support** in exchange for independence after the war; Britain **refused**
- **"Chauri Chaura was an unprovoked attack" → FALSE.** The police had **fired on a peaceful demonstration**

Mains

- ★★ ★ "Trace the various stages of the freedom struggle from the Moderates to Quit India."
- ★★ ★ "Discuss the various forms the Non-Cooperation Movement took in different parts of India, and how people understood Gandhiji." — **the regional table plus the CID report**
- ★★ ★ "Why did Gandhi choose salt?" — the **uniting-not-dividing** argument, plus the century-long history of the grievance
- ★★ ★ "Assess the developments of 1937–47 that made Partition inevitable." — the **five reasons**, including the two Congress failures
- ★★ ★ **GS1 (women):** "For many women, the freedom struggle was personal liberation before it was national liberation." — **Ambabai**, and the fact that participation **had to be fought for**
- ★★ **Contributors from different parts of the country** (an explicit syllabus phrase): **Lakhan Nayak** (Orissa), **Badshah Khan** (NWFP), **Ambabai** (Karnataka), **Akalis** (Punjab), **Guntur forest satyagrahis** (Andhra), **Assam tea labourers**
- ★★ **Polity:** GoI Act 1935 → 1937 ministries → Cabinet Mission → the Constituent Assembly

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Sovereign	The capacity to act independently without outside interference
Sarvajanik	"Of or for all the people"
Publicist	One who publicises an idea through writing and speaking
Repeal	To officially end the validity of a law
Revolutionary violence	Violence used to make a radical change in society
Council	An appointed or elected body with administrative, advisory or representative functions
Swaraj / Purna Swaraj	Self-rule / complete independence
Hartal	A strike
Satyagraha	Insistence on truth; Gandhi's method of non-violent resistance
Picket	Protesting outside a building to prevent others entering
Mahant	A religious functionary of a Sikh gurdwara
Illegal eviction (bedakhli)	Unlawful throwing out of tenants
Knighthood	A British Crown honour
Provincial autonomy	Provinces making relatively independent decisions within a federation
"General" constituencies	Election districts with no communal reservation
Prabhat pheri	Early-morning procession singing patriotic songs
Wahadat-i-deen	The essential oneness of all religions

3-MINUTE RECAP

1. ★ **The founding idea:** "India was the people of India — **all** the people irrespective of class, colour, caste, creed, language or gender" — and therefore British control was illegitimate. The associations worked for **popular sovereignty**, "a modern consciousness and a key feature of nationalism."

2. **Three provocations:** the **Arms Act (1878)**, the **Vernacular Press Act (1878)**, and the **Ilbert Bill (1883)** — withdrawn under **white opposition**, exposing British racial attitudes and **deepening the desire for an all-India body**.
3. ★ **The Congress, Bombay, December 1885**, 72 delegates; **Naoroji, Tyabji, Bonnerji, Surendranath Banerji, Pherozeshah Mehta, R. C. Dutt, Subramania Iyer**, with **A. O. Hume's** help.
4. ★ **The Moderates** demanded representative councils, **civil service exams in India**, separation of judiciary and executive, repeal of the Arms Act — and raised **the salt tax, indentured labour and forest dwellers**. **Indianisation** would fight racism and **reduce the drain of wealth**. Their method was **persuasion**, on the belief that the British **would accept just demands**.
5. ★ **The Radicals — Lal, Bal, Pal** — attacked the "**politics of prayers**", demanded **self-reliance and swaraj**: "*Freedom is my birthright and I shall have it.*"
6. ★ ★ **Curzon partitioned Bengal in 1905** — "administrative convenience" that **split the Bengali people** and merged East Bengal with **Assam**. The ★ **Swadeshi movement** followed: self-help, swadeshi enterprise, **national education, boycott**, and in Andhra the **Vandemataram Movement**.
7. **1906** the **Muslim League** at **Dacca** (supporting the partition, seeking **separate electorates**, conceded **1909** — which **tempted politicians to court their own religious groups**); **1907** the **Congress split**; **December 1915** reunion; **1916** the **Lucknow Pact**.
8. ★ ★ **The First World War** raised taxes and prices, enriched **Indian business**, forced **village recruitment**, returned soldiers with anti-imperial ideas, and — with the **1917 Russian Revolution** — inspired mass politics. **After 1919 the movement became a mass movement**.
9. ★ ★ **Gandhi arrived in 1915, aged 46**, already experienced at organising **across religion, region and class** in South Africa; spent a year travelling; then **Champaran, Kheda and Ahmedabad (millworkers' strike, 1918)**.
10. ★ ★ **Rowlatt Satyagraha**: hartal on **6 April 1919**, the **first all-India struggle**, largely urban. ★ **Jallianwala Bagh** — **General Dyer, Amritsar, Baisakhi, 13 April 1919** — and **Tagore renounced his knighthood**.
11. ★ ★ **Khilafat + Non-Cooperation**: led by **Mohammad Ali and Shaukat Ali**; Gandhi's three demands were **Punjab wrongs, the Khilafat wrong, and swaraj**. Students left colleges, lawyers gave up practice, titles were surrendered, **foreign cloth burnt**.
12. ★ ★ ★ **It took different forms everywhere**: Kheda's **Patidars**, liquor picketing in Andhra and Tamil Nadu, **forest satyagrahas in Guntur** where people proclaimed "**Gandhi Raj**", enthusiasm in **Sind**, communal unity in **Bengal**, the **Akali agitation** in Punjab, and **Assam tea labourers** shouting "**Gandhi Maharaj ki Jai**" — with **Krishna replaced by "Gandhi Raja"** in Vaishnava songs.
13. ★ ★ **The people's Mahatma**: the CID reported that "*no one seems to know quite who or what he is, but... what he says is so*", and that villagers thought him **against zamindars but not the Sarkar** — "*We are for Gandhiji and the Sarkar.*"
14. ★ ★ **Chauri Chaura, February 1922** — **22 policemen killed** after the police **fired on a peaceful demonstration** — and Gandhi **called off the movement**. Then **constructive village work** (which built the base for **1930**) and **council entry** under **C. R. Das and Motilal Nehru**. **RSS** and the **CPI** were formed; **Bhagat Singh's HSRA (1928)** killed **Saunders** and bombed the **Assembly (1929)** "**to make the deaf hear**"; executed **23 March 1931, aged 23**.
15. ★ ★ **Simon Commission (1927)** had **no Indian member** — "**Simon Go Back**". **Purna Swaraj (1929)** under **Nehru**; **Independence Day, 26 January 1930**.
16. ★ ★ ★ **Dandi**: salt was chosen because it **related the general desire for freedom to a grievance shared by everybody and did not divide rich from poor**. Over **240 miles, Sabarmati to Dandi, 6 April 1930**.

17. ★★ **Women: Ambabai**, married at **12** and widowed at **16**, picketed at **Udipi**, was jailed twice, and called these **the happiest days of her life**. ⚠️ **Participation had to be fought for — Gandhi was initially opposed, and Sarojini Naidu (first Indian woman Congress President, 1925) persuaded him.**
 18. ★★ **GoI Act 1935** gave **provincial autonomy**; the Congress won **7 of 11 provinces in 1937** and **resigned in 1939** when Britain refused independence in return for war support.
 19. ★★★ **Quit India, 1942: "do or die" — non-violently.** Leaders jailed at once, but **communications and symbols of authority were attacked** and ★ **in many areas people set up their own governments. Over 90,000 arrested, ~1,000 killed, crowds machine-gunned from aircraft — yet it "brought the Raj to its knees."**
 20. ★★ **Bose** left Calcutta in **January 1941** via Germany to Singapore, raised the **Azad Hind Fauj**, failed at **Imphal and Kohima in 1944** — but the **INA trials** brought people **from all walks of life** onto the streets.
 21. ★★★ **Partition:** the **1940 resolution** asked for **"Independent States", not Pakistan**. The League's shift owed to the **1937 elections** convincing it Muslims would be a permanent minority, the **Congress's refusal of a coalition in the UP**, and the **Congress's failure to mobilise Muslim masses** — the League growing fastest **while Congress leaders were in jail**. The **Cabinet Mission (March 1946)** proposed a **united confederation** and failed; **Direct Action Day, 16 August 1946**, brought riots in **Calcutta**; by **March 1947** violence had spread across northern India.
 22. ★★ **Hundreds of thousands were killed, millions displaced.** *"The joy of our country's independence from British rule came mixed with the pain and violence of Partition."*
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Test Yourself

Prelims style

1. Consider the following statements about the Indian National Congress:
 1. It was founded at Bombay in December 1885 with 72 delegates.
 2. A. O. Hume, a retired British official, helped bring Indians together.
 3. Its early leadership was drawn largely from Bombay and Calcutta. → *All three.*
2. The Ilbert Bill controversy of 1883 is significant because — → *The bill sought equality between British and Indian judges, and its withdrawal after white opposition exposed British racial attitudes and spurred the demand for an all-India organisation.*
3. Consider the following:
 1. The All India Muslim League was founded at Dacca in 1906.
 2. It opposed the partition of Bengal.
 3. Separate electorates were conceded in 1909. → *1 and 3 only. The League **supported** the partition of Bengal.*
4. Why did Gandhiji choose to break the salt law? → *Because salt was an essential item taxed by a state monopoly, so the issue united rich and poor and related the general desire for freedom to a universally shared grievance.*
5. The Muslim League resolution of 1940 — → *Demanded "Independent States" for Muslims in the north-western and eastern areas; it did **not** mention Partition or Pakistan.*
6. Consider the following statements about the Quit India movement:
 1. Gandhi's call was "do or die", but the fight was to be non-violent.
 2. By the end of 1943 over 90,000 people had been arrested.

3. In many areas people set up their own governments. → *All three.*

Mains style

7. Trace the transformation of the national movement from the Moderates to the mass movements after 1919. **(250 words)**
8. Discuss the various forms the Non-Cooperation Movement took in different parts of India, and what they reveal about how people understood Gandhi. **(250 words)**
9. Examine the developments between 1937 and 1947 that made Partition inevitable. **(250 words)**
10. *"For many Indian women, participation in the freedom struggle was an act of personal as well as national liberation."* Discuss. **(250 words)**

Self-check (out loud, no notes):

- State the nationalist answer to "what is India and for whom is it meant?"
- Name the three provocations of 1878–1883.
- Give four Moderate demands and two reasons for Indianisation.
- Name the Radicals and their regions, and Tilak's slogan.
- Give five effects of the First World War on India.
- Name six regional forms of Non-Cooperation.
- Explain why salt, and give the distance and dates of the march.
- Give the five reasons NCERT offers for the League's turn to a separate demand.

CLASS 8 COMPLETE

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| 8 chapters - 1750 to 1947 - the conquest, the countryside, |
| the revolt, the reforms, and the freedom struggle.         |
|                                                             |
| This is the book that carries the most marks in the entire |
| NCERT History series. Revise Ch.2, Ch.3, Ch.5, Ch.7 and    |
| Ch.8 until you can narrate them without notes.             |
|                                                             |
| NEXT: Class 10 (Nationalism in India) and Class 12        |
| Part III deepen exactly this material for Mains.           |
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